Steve Hall — Discovery Meeting Script

Dataverse Mapping & Phase 1 Scoping

Client: Steve Hall · stevehall11565@gmail.com **Account Owner:** Derek Nwamadi · derek.nwamadi@improving.com · M. 214.385.1603 **Principal Technologist:** Bud Marrical · $180/hr **Executive Sponsor:** David O'Hara (value-add, no bill) **Engagement Type:** T&M · Phase 1 — Baseline IES Platform **CRM:** Dynamics — AI Implementation Plan · Est. Close 03/06/2026

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OPENING (5 MIN)

Set the tone. Steve is relationship-driven, writes "with care," and is genuinely excited about this. He's not a typical enterprise client — this is deeply personal and tied to his advisory/board roles.

Key framing: "Steve, the goal today is to build a complete map of your digital world — every system, every data source, every workflow. The better we understand where things live and how they connect, the faster we can get your IES up and running. Think of this as us taking inventory before we build the command center."

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1. GOOGLE ECOSYSTEM — THE CORE (15 MIN)

Steve's primary data lives in Google. This is the foundation of everything.

GMAIL

- **Which Gmail accounts are active?** (Personal: stevehall11565@gmail.com — any others? Business-specific accounts?)
- **Approximate volume?** (How many emails per day/week? How far back does history go?)
- **Do you use labels, folders, or filters?** (Understanding structure tells us what's already organized)
- **Are there email accounts on other platforms?** (Any Microsoft/Outlook for specific businesses? Any dealership-specific email?)

> ***CAPTURE:*** *Gmail accounts & estimated volume*

GOOGLE CALENDAR

- **How many calendars are you managing?** (Personal, business, foundation, dealership-specific?)
- **Are other people scheduling on your behalf?** (Assistants, office managers?)
- **Do any of your businesses use a different calendar system?** (Dealerships sometimes use their own scheduling tools)

> ***CAPTURE:*** *Calendar accounts & who manages them*

GOOGLE DRIVE / DOCS

- **Where do your documents live?** (Personal Drive, Shared Drives, specific folder structures?)
- **What types of documents matter most?** (Board decks, financial reports, strategic memos, foundation content)
- **Are there documents scattered across other platforms?** (Dropbox, iCloud, local hard drive?)
- **How do you organize things today?** (Folders by business? By date? Or is it "search and pray"?)

> ***CAPTURE:*** *Document storage locations & structure*

GOOGLE CONTACTS

- **Is Google Contacts your primary contact database?** (Or is there a CRM, Rolodex, or other system?)
- **How do you track relationships today?** (Notes on contacts? Separate spreadsheet? Memory?)

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CAPTURE: *Contact management approach*

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2. THE BUSINESS PORTFOLIO — ENTITY MAPPING (15 MIN)

Steve operates across multiple businesses. Each one may have its own data universe.

> ***REMINDER:*** *Don't just ask about the businesses — ask about the SYSTEMS each business uses. That's where the integration complexity lives.*

AUTOMOTIVE DEALERSHIPS

- **Which dealerships do you own/operate?** (Known: Denver Bentley, Honda of Paris — others?)
- **What Dealer Management System (DMS) does each use?** (Reynolds & Reynolds? CDK Global? Dealertrack? Other?)

> ***PROBE:*** *Bud flagged DMS as the hard part. For each DMS: - Is it cloud-hosted or on-premise? - Does it have an API or export capability? - Who manages it day-to-day? (GM? Controller? Third party?) - What data do you actually want from it? (Sales figures? Inventory? F&I metrics? Customer data?)*

- **What financial reporting do you get from the dealerships?** (Monthly P&L? DMS reports? Separate accounting system?)
- **Who sends you these reports, and in what format?** (PDF? Excel? Email summary?)

> ***CAPTURE:*** *Dealerships, DMS systems, and reporting*

Dealership	*DMS*	*Cloud/On-Prem*	*API?*	*Key Contact*

AUTO FINANCE COMPANY

- **What platform does the finance company run on?** (Custom? SaaS? Legacy system?)
- **What data matters most here?** (Loan portfolio performance? Delinquency rates? New originations?)
- **Is there overlap with the dealership data?** (F&I deals flowing into the finance company?)

> ***CAPTURE:*** *Finance company systems & data*

FOUNDATION / NONPROFIT

- **What tools does the foundation use?** (Donor management? Grant tracking? Content publishing?)
- **Where does foundation content get drafted and stored?** (Google Docs? Word? Notion?)
- **Who else works on foundation content?** (Staff? Board members? Ghostwriters?)

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> ***CAPTURE:*** *Foundation tools & workflows*

OTHER INVESTMENTS / ADVISORY ROLES

- **What other businesses or boards are you actively involved with?**
- **Do any of them share data with you regularly?** (Board decks, quarterly reports, strategic briefs?)
- **What format does that data arrive in?** (Email attachments? Portal access? Shared drives?)

> ***CAPTURE:*** *Advisory roles & data they generate*

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3. JOURNALS & PERSONAL KNOWLEDGE (10 MIN)

Steve specifically mentioned journals as a primary data source for Phase 1.

- **What do you mean by "journals"?** (Physical notebooks? Digital notes? Voice memos? A journaling app?)
- **If digital, where do they live?** (Google Docs? Apple Notes? Day One? Evernote? Something else?)
- **If physical, are you open to digitizing them?** (Scanning? Dictation? Photo capture?)
- **How often do you journal?** (Daily? Weekly? Situationally?)
- **What goes into the journals?** (Strategic thinking? Meeting notes? Personal reflection? Ideas for businesses?)

> ***REMINDER:*** *This is where Steve's "stop typing first drafts" use case lives. Understanding his journaling workflow tells us how to capture his thinking at the source.*
>
> ***CAPTURE:*** *Journal format, location, and frequency*

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4. COMMUNICATION PATTERNS & WORKFLOWS (10 MIN)

Steve wants AI to analyze how he spends time and who he communicates with most.

- **What's your primary communication tool?** (Email? Text? Phone calls? WhatsApp?)
- **Do you use any messaging apps for business?** (Slack? Teams? Signal? Group texts?)
- **Who are the 5-10 people you communicate with most?** (Operators, advisors, family, foundation?)
- **What does your typical day look like?** (Morning routine? Meeting-heavy? Travel schedule?)
- **Where do to-dos live today?** (A list? An app? Your head? Post-its?)
- **Do you use any task management tools?** (Todoist? Apple Reminders? Google Tasks? Nothing formal?)

> ***CAPTURE:*** *Primary communication channels & task management*

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5. HARDWARE & DEVICES (5 MIN)

Need to know what Steve carries and uses daily.

- **What devices do you use?** (iPhone? iPad? Mac? PC? All of the above?)
- **What's your primary "work" device?** (The one you're on most of the day)
- **Do you dictate or use voice input?** (Siri? Voice memos? This matters for the "stop typing" use case)
- **Do you use any smart home / connected devices that might be relevant?** (Smart speakers, displays, etc.)

> ***CAPTURE:*** *Devices & preferences*

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6. SECURITY & ACCESS (5 MIN)

> ***REMINDER:*** *Steve's data is deeply personal AND business-sensitive. Handle this section with care.*

- **Do you use two-factor authentication on your Google accounts?** (Needed for API access)
- **Are there any accounts managed by someone else?** (IT admin at a dealership? An assistant?)
- **Are there any data sources that are off-limits or require special handling?** (Compliance, privacy, NDA-covered materials?)
- **Who else should have access to what we build?** (Just Steve? An assistant? Business partners?)
- **Any existing security tools?** (Password manager? VPN? Google Advanced Protection?)

> ***CAPTURE:*** *Access & security considerations*

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7. SUCCESS CRITERIA — WHAT "DONE" LOOKS LIKE (10 MIN)

Before closing, nail down what Steve expects Phase 1 to deliver.

- **When you picture the IES working, what's the first thing you'd do with it?** (This reveals the highest-priority use case)
- **What would make you say "this was worth every penny" after Phase 1?**
- **Is there a specific pain point that, if solved, would be the biggest win?**
- **How do you want to interact with it?** (Chat interface? Dashboard? Email-based? Voice?)
- **How quickly do you want to start seeing value?** (Are there quick wins we should prioritize?)

> ***PROBE:*** *Steve mentioned these specific use cases in his initial emails. Confirm which ones are Phase 1 priorities:*

Use Case	*Phase 1?*	*Notes*
Shadow Board Agent (board deck analysis)		
Moat Builder (F&I simulation)		
Sentiment & Regulatory Agent		
Financial Reconciliation Agent		
Foundation content drafting		
Market research & tracking		
Email analysis & time allocation		
Email response generation		
To-do follow-up		
Synthetic Negotiations		

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8. CLOSE & NEXT STEPS (5 MIN)

- **Summarize what you heard** — Play back the dataverse map to Steve. Confirm you got it right.
- **Identify the first three data connections** — What do we plug in first? (Almost certainly Gmail, Calendar, Drive)
- **Confirm who provides access** — Steve directly? An assistant? IT contact at a dealership?
- **Set the next meeting** — When do we reconvene to show progress?
- **Deliverable from this meeting:** We'll produce a written Dataverse Map with every system, data source, and integration pathway documented. Steve reviews and confirms before we start building.

> ***REMINDER:*** *Steve said he's "hyper-sensitive" about pulling Improving's focus from enterprise work. Reassure him again that this is a mutual learning opportunity and David is personally invested.*

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QUICK REFERENCE — WHAT WE ALREADY KNOW

Source	Detail
Email	stevehall11565@gmail.com (Google ecosystem)
Businesses	Denver Bentley dealership, Honda of Paris, auto finance company
Foundation	Family foundation — white papers, leadership covenants, Stewardship Mandates
Phase 1 Focus	Baseline IES: emails, documents, journals
DMS Warning	Bud: "Once we start handling potentially multiple DMS integrations there will be dragons"
Timeline	4 weeks for general assistant part; DMS = extended
Relationship	YPO GOLD member, wine club at 55 Seventy (Preston Center), deeply relational
Budget	T&M, requested NTE cap for Phase 1, wants hourly rate clarity

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